

Back Up Your Files with Déjà Dup

This is a guide to using the packages Déjà Dup and Duplicity for backups on desktops and workstations. While Déjà Dup, which rides on the backbone of Duplicity, has a graphical user interface, Duplicity is for code lovers.



It was just another day. I turned on the computer, and started listing the day's work in my mind while it booted. But to my surprise, the monitor showed the message, 'Hard disk not found'. At first, I thought it could be a loose connection, which is nothing to worry about. But then I recalled the previous day's programming experiments and realised that I had damaged the file system of my hard disk! Thanks to TestDisk (cgsecurity.org), I was able to recover the entire disk with all the partitions and files. Not a single file was lost. Even the bootloader was restored.

But this does not imply that any disk damage can be undone and everything can be recovered. I knew I was lucky this time. So after this episode, I started to take frequent backups of important data.

Before getting introduced to some important backup utilities for desktops and workstations, let's discuss the importance of data backups.

When recoveries fail and backups succeed

Data recovery and backup are the two options you have when important files get lost. The third one is starting everything from scratch, which drives you crazy. You perform recovery when you delete some files accidentally, or your disk is damaged, partially, while data backup is a process of creating duplicates of your data frequently and restoring them when needed. Data recovery just retrieves what is lost, i.e., you have nothing to do unless you have lost something. You may not feel the need for data backup, but be aware that it is the right and best method to safeguard data.

As mentioned earlier, there are many tools like TestDisk, which can recover your whole hard disk. But recovering lost data from a disk always comes with some challenges. Recovery depends on a single storage device and any negative parameter related to it can ruin the entire process. Sometimes the disk is physically damaged; or the